Music Heading Authority Records

H 250

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A. Background

This instruction sheet provides guidelines for establishing headings for musical compositions. For guidelines on establishing headings for musical instruments, see H 1918.

B. Recent revisions

2025-06: Updated to new template.

C. Creating authority records for music

C.1. General rule

Authority records are required for headings of the types described below. In general, do not add a broader term if the heading contains or implies a medium of performance, or a number of players, or is a term for a generic form of instrumental music such as *__Canons, fugues, etc.__*; *__Sonatas__*; *__Toccatas__*; etc. Some additional guidelines concerning references appear in the relevant sections below.

C.1.a. Headings consisting of single word or term

C.1.a.i. Music for a single instrument or a single performer

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Drum set music
150 ## $a Plucked instrument music
150 ## $a Violin music
```

C.1.a.ii. Music for ensembles of instruments or singers

In general, establish terms that do not include the word music in the plural.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Band music
150 ## $a Choruses, Sacred
150 ## $a Clarinet choir music
150 ## $a Instrumental ensembles
150 ## $a Nonets
150 ## $a Orchestral music
150 ## $a String quartets
```

```
150 ## $a Vocal trios
```

C.1.a.iii. Styles, types, genres, etc., of music

Establish terms that do not include the word music in the plural unless a plural is not idiomatic.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Blues (Music)
150 ## $a Carnatic music
150 ## $a Honkyoku
150 ## $a Foxtrots
150 ## $a Jazz
150 ## $a Oratorios
```

If appropriate in records for styles of music, include a see also reference to other headings that may contain a qualifier for the style, and a scope note to indicate the number of performers, if more than two.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Alternative rock music
360 ## $i headings for music of individual instruments followed by the
       qualifier "(Alternative rock)" and the subdivisions $a Methods
       (Alternative rock) $i and $a Studies and exercises (Alternative rock)
       $i under individual musical instruments and families of instruments
680 ## $i This heading is assigned to alternative rock music for two or more
       performers


150 ## $a Gospel music
360 ## $i subdivisions $a Methods (Gospel) $i and $a Studies and exercises
       (Gospel) $i under individual musical instruments and families of
       instruments
```

Do not add such references and notes when the style of music is not needed as a qualifier either in a heading for music for a solo instrument or in a free-floating subdivision for an instructional work.

C.1.a.iv. Musical settings of certain sacred texts

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Psalms (Music)
150 ## $a Te Deum laudamus (Music)
```

C.1.b. Headings consisting of combinations of terms

Headings that consist of combinations of terms must be separately established, unless the headings are governed by the patterns described in sec. D.

C.1.b.i. Music of a single instrument qualified by style of music or playing

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Trumpet music (Jazz)
150 ## $a Piano music (Ragtime)
150 ## $a Bass guitar music (Rock)
```

The term in the qualifier must also be established as a heading for music in that style.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Jazz
150 ## $a Ragtime music
150 ## $a Rock music
```

Include in the record for the music style of the instrument a broader term for the style.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Trumpet music (Jazz)
550 ## $w g $a Jazz

150 ## $a Piano music (Ragtime)
550 ## $w g $a Ragtime music

150 ## $a Bass guitar music (Rock)
550 ## $w g $a Rock music
```

C.1.b.ii. Music for combinations of two instruments

Provide references from the instruments in reverse order or from other appropriate phrases.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Duets (Unspecified instrument and cittern)
450 ## $a Duets (Cittern and unspecified instrument)

150 ## $a Piano music (Pianos (2))
```

```
450 ## $a Piano duets

150 ## $a Violin and piano music
450 ## $a Piano and violin music
```

C.1.b.iii. Headings with qualifiers for language of text

Establish the heading in inverted form (cf. H 306, sec. 2). Provide a reference from the direct form. The language, language group, or dialect must also be established.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Buddhist hymns, Japanese
450 ## $a Japanese Buddhist hymns

150 ## $a Folk songs, Norwegian
450 ## $a Norwegian folk songs

150 ## $a Children's songs, Papiamentu
450 ## $a Papiamentu children's songs
```

C.2. Special rules for certain categories of headings

C.2.a. Headings that may be qualified by language

The following headings may be qualified by language of text.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Ballads
150 ## $a Buddhist hymns
150 ## $a Bhajans
150 ## $a Canzonets (Part songs)
150 ## $a Carols
150 ## $a Children's songs
150 ## $a Folk songs
150 ## $a Hindu hymns
150 ## $a Hymns
150 ## $a Jaina hymns
150 ## $a Part songs
150 ## $a Revolutionary ballads and songs
```

```
150 ## $a Sikh hymns
150 ## $a Songs
```

Do not add the language to the headings *__Sacred songs__* or *__Part songs, Sacred__*. Instead, generally assign a second heading with the language and without the term sacred.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Sacred songs.
650 #0 $a Songs, Provençal.

650 #0 $a Part songs, Italian.
650 #0 $a Part songs, Sacred.
```

C.2.b. Addition of the qualifier ", Arranged"

Authority records are required when adding ", Arranged" to headings for vocal forms and instrumental forms that do not imply medium of performance (cf. H 1917.5, sec 7).

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Incidental music, Arranged
150 ## $a Motion picture music, Arranged
150 ## $a Oratorios, Arranged
```

C.2.c. Dances

C.2.c.i. The qualifier "(Music)"

Establish new headings representing types of dance music with the qualifier (Music) even if there is no corresponding heading for the dance. Establish new dance headings with the qualifier (Dance) even if there is no corresponding heading for the music for that dance. Do not retrospectively add a qualifier to the music heading when a corresponding new dance heading is established.

C.2.c.ii. Medium of performance

Headings for the music of individual dances are not qualified by medium of performance. If appropriate when cataloging dance music, add a second heading for medium of performance.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Hulas (Music)
650 #0 $a Guitar music (Slack key)
```

```
650 #0 $a Waltzes.
650 #0 $a Orchestral music.
```

C.3. Recorded accompaniments

Recorded accompaniments are sound recordings with performance parts omitted so they can be performed by live musicians. Parenthetical qualifiers added to the heading ***Recorded accompaniments*** specify the medium of performance of the missing part(s), and not the medium of performance on the recording. Authority records are required for the headings with their qualifier. Make a related term reference to a general heading for unaccompanied music for the live performer and include a scope note explaining the unusual meaning of the heading.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Recorded accompaniments (Flute)
550 ## $a Flute music
680 ## $a Here are entered musical sound recordings to be played while a
       live performer plays the flute part.

150 ## $a Recorded accompaniments (High voice)
550 ## $a Songs (High voice)
680 ## $a Here are entered musical sound recordings to be played while a
       live performer sings the voice part.
```

C.4. Cross references for headings that specify medium of performance

With the exception of music for combinations of two instruments described in sec. C.1.b.ii above, no cross references or broader terms are given in authority records for headings containing combinations of terms for medium of performance by solo performers (cf. sec. D.1 below and H 1917.5).

Example:

```
150 ## $a Concertos (Oboe and harp)
150 ## $a Piano, flute, violin with instrumental ensemble
150 ## $a Woodwind quartets (Bassoon, clarinet, English horn, oboe)
```

D. Pattern headings

No authority records are required for headings that conform to the patterns described below.

D.1. Pattern: Medium of performance

Medium of performance is the vocal, instrumental, or other performers for which individual musical works are written. Listed below are the four categories of headings to which terms for medium of performance can be added as needed. H 1917.5 describes the categories and their components in detail, and also includes instructions on creating authority records for general see also references.

Note: The subject authority file contains a large number of headings for forms, types, and genres of music that consist of or include medium of performance. With the exceptions indicated in sec. C.1 above, in general, these types of headings are no longer established because:

1. the patterns for the order of musical instruments in headings have existed for some time;
2. cross references giving the terms for medium of performance in alternative order are no longer made; and
3. the headings already in the subject authority file amply illustrate the patterns.

Authority records are now created only to provide examples of the use of particular mediums of performance, such as those that are new.

D.1.a. Headings that contain a word for the number of performers

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Trios, [Quartets, Quintets, etc.]
150 ## $a Brass trios, [quartets, quintets, etc.]
150 ## $a String trios, [quartets, quintets, etc.]
150 ## $a Wind trios, [quartets, quintets, etc.]
150 ## $a Woodwind trios, [quartets, quintets, etc.]
150 ## $a Sacred vocal duets, [trios, quartets, etc.]
150 ## $a Vocal duets, [trios, quartets, etc.]
```

D.1.b. Headings for form, genre, type, etc., of music

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Canons, fugues, etc.
150 ## $a Chaconnes
150 ## $a Chorale preludes
```

```
150 ## $a Concertos
150 ## $a Marches
150 ## $a Monologues with music
150 ## $a Overtures
150 ## $a Passacaglias
150 ## $a Potpourris
150 ## $a Rondos
150 ## $a Sacred monologues with music
150 ## $a Scherzos
150 ## $a Sonatas
150 ## $a Suites
150 ## $a Symphonic poems
150 ## $a Symphonies
150 ## $a Trio sonatas
150 ## $a Variations
```

D.1.c. Certain headings for vocal music

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Choruses
150 ## $a Choruses, Sacred
150 ## $a Choruses, Secular
150 ## $a Sacred songs
150 ## $a Songs
150 ## $a Vocalises
```

D.1.d. Headings for accompanying ensemble

An accompanying ensemble may be added to headings for solo instrument(s) and solo vocal music, as long as the ensemble has itself been established. The pattern applies to the connecting word “with” and the terms for the accompaniment that follow it.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Piano music
150 ## $a Chamber orchestra music
650 #0 $a Piano with chamber orchestra.

150 ## $a Violin and piano music
```

```
150 ## $a String orchestra music
```

These headings authorize:

```
650 #0 $a Violin and piano with string orchestra.
```

```
150 ## $a Chamber orchestra music
150 ## $a Clarinet music
150 ## $a Flute music
150 ## $a Violin music
150 ## $a Cello music
```

These headings authorize:

```
650 #0 $a Clarinet, flute, violin, cello with chamber orchestra.
```

```
150 ## $a Songs
150 ## $a Piano music
```

These headings authorize:

```
650 #0 $a Songs (High voice) with piano.
```

```
150 ## $a String quartet
150 ## $a Instrumental ensemble
```

These headings authorize:

```
650 #0 $a String quartet with instrumental ensemble.
```

D.2. Pattern: Musical format

This pattern applies to the free-floating form subdivisions that characterize the physical format and some standard types of arrangement of the music. The subdivisions are listed in H 1160.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Concertos (Violin) $v Solo with piano.
650 #0 $a Operas $v Vocal scores with piano.
650 #0 $a Piano music (Pianos (2)) $v Scores.
650 #0 $a Symphonies $v 2-piano scores.
650 #0 $a Wind quintets (Bassoon, clarinet, flute, horn, oboe) $v Scores and
       parts.
```

D.3. Pattern: Singuar/plural form

Names of musical instruments established in the singular may be used also in the plural as may be needed to specify medium of performance in form/genre headings for musical works. Conversely, types of instrumental ensembles established in the plural may also be used in the singular. For additional guidelines, see H 1917.5 and H 1918.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Bassoon music
150 ## $a Clarinet music
150 ## $a Horn music
150 ## $a Oboe music
```

These headings authorize "bassoons," "clarinets," "horns," "oboes," as used in:

```
650 #0 $a Wind nonets (Bassoons (3), clarinets (2), horns (2), oboes (2))
```

```
150 ## $a Instrumental ensembles
```

This heading authorizes "instrumental ensemble," as used in:

```
650 #0 $a Trumpet with instrumental ensemble.
```

D.4. Pattern: Qualifier to distinguish homographs

If the name of a musical instrument must be established with a qualifier to show the term belongs to music and not some other field, omit the qualifier when the instrument appears as a medium of performance in form/genre headings for musical compositions.

Examples:

Heading established for the instrument:

```
150 ## $a Horn (Musical instrument)
```

Instrument as a medium of performance:

```
150 ## $a Horn and organ music
650 #0 $a Sonatas (Horn and organ)
```

If the name of an instrument has been established with a qualifier to distinguish it from another instrument with the same name, retain the qualifier when the instrument is used as a medium of performance in form/genre headings for musical compositions.

Examples:

```
150 ## $a Tar (Lute)
```

["Tar" is also the term for several types of drum]

150 ## $a Tar (Lute) and zarb music

However, when the same term is used for two or more instruments and one usage is clearly better known, that heading does not need a qualifier.

Examples:

Headings established for the instruments:

150 ## $a Guiro *[predominantly a scraper]*

150 ## $a Atcheré

450 ## $a Guiro (Rattle) *[alternate name for the atcheré, a rattle]*

Instrument as a medium of performance:

150 ## $a Flute and guiro music

D.5. Pattern: Free-floating subdivisions used under instruments

Instruction sheet H 1161 lists the free-floating subdivisions that may be used under headings for individual musical instruments and families of instruments. For subdivisions that include a qualifier for type or style of music, the instrument must be established and the term in the qualifier for type or style of music must be established as a heading and in the subdivision list.

Examples:

150 ## $a Electric guitar

150 ## $a Alternative rock music

185 ## $v Methods (Alternative rock)

These headings authorize:

650 #0 $a Electric guitar $v Methods (Alternative rock)

E. Geographic subdivision

Headings covered by this instruction sheet may be subdivided geographically. If the current authority record is not coded i in the 008/06 position, email PTCP to request its change. See H 1160, sec. 3; H 1916.5 sec. 3; and H 1917 sec. 2.c. for guidance on when to assign geographic subdivisions to headings for musical works.

Revision history

2025-06: Updated to new template.

2024-08: Updated to new template. Corrected typo. Removed LC practice section, which is no longer accurate.